TAILORLY

Project Handbook & Progress Guide

A plain-language guide to what we are building, who uses it, how every feature works, and how to track progress.

THE BIG IDEA
One Tailorly platform. One codebase. One shared system. Many independent tailoring businesses, each with its own branded online shop.

Prepared for the Tailorly product owner

Working product name: Tailorly | Prepared: 31 October 2026

This handbook is for understanding the project and measuring delivery. It is not a claim that the software has already been built.

How to use this handbook

Keep this PDF as your product-owner reference. Use it to understand what Tailorly should do, explain requirements to Copilot or a developer, review demonstrations, and record what has actually been completed.

- Before a feature is built: check what the feature should do and which users are allowed to use it.
- During development: ask for a demonstration, tests and a list of changed files—not just a screenshot.
- After development: mark a feature complete only when it works, has been tested and respects shop privacy.
- At every milestone: update the progress tracker near the end of this handbook.

Important status key

Status	Meaning
Confirmed	A product decision already stated or selected.
Approved	A feature or document explicitly approved for inclusion.
Proposed — confirm	A recommendation that still needs your yes/no approval.
Open decision	A detail that has not been selected yet.
Not started / In progress / Testing / Complete	Development progress. Complete means working and verified, not merely designed.

Project at a glance

Item	Current direction
Product	Tailorly — multi-tenant SaaS for tailors and fashion designers.
Core model	One project and codebase serving the main Tailorly site, many shop storefronts and role-based dashboards.
Frontend / application	Next.js App Router + TypeScript + Tailwind CSS.
Database	MongoDB with Mongoose.
Media	Cloudinary.
Payments	Paystack.
Real-time communication	Socket.IO.
Additional approved direction	Redis, Vitest, Playwright and Docker; use where justified.
Initial verification	Email verification; no SMS verification in initial scope.

1. What exactly is Tailorly?

Tailorly is a digital business platform for tailors and fashion designers. A shop owner can create a branded online store, display fashion products and services, receive orders, manage customers and staff, follow sewing work, collect payments and grow the business.

Tailorly is not a collection of unrelated websites. It is one software product with different experiences depending on the web address and the signed-in person's permissions.

The three connected experiences

Experience	What visitors use it for	Example
1. Main Tailorly website	Learn about Tailorly, see benefits, read information, meet the creator and start registration.	tailorly.com
2. Shop storefronts	Visit an individual tailor's branded shop, browse products and place orders.	royalstitches.tailorly.com
3. Management dashboards	Manage the platform, a shop, staff tasks or a customer's own activity.	Role-protected dashboard

How the parts connect

The root domain belongs to Tailorly itself. Each shop gets a unique subdomain or, later, its own custom domain. The same application detects which domain was visited and loads the correct experience. The dashboard then checks the user's role for that platform or shop.

A simple mental picture: Tailorly is the shopping-centre operator; each tailor is an independent shop inside the centre. The shops share the building's infrastructure, but each controls its own products, customers, orders and branding.

Main Tailorly public pages

- Home / Landing Page
- About Tailorly
- How Tailorly Works
- For Tailors
- Features & Benefits
- Meet the Creator
- FAQ & Help Centre
- Contact Us
- Get Started / Sign Up

The Meet the Creator page should use truthful information, genuine photos and the owner's actual portfolio and social links. Do not invent achievements or testimonials.

2. How accounts and shop registration work

A customer should not need a different account for every tailor. Tailorly gives each person one universal account. Their relationship with each shop is recorded separately.

Example: a customer visits Royal Stitches and registers. Tailorly creates one user account and records that the customer has a relationship with Royal Stitches. Later, the same person visits Elegant Styles and logs in with the same email and password. They do not need to register again.

Question	Expected behaviour
Where does registration happen?	On the shop website the person is visiting, or through Tailorly onboarding. The current URL identifies the shop context.
Does the customer get a new account for each shop?	No. One universal account.
Will Shop A's products appear inside Shop B?	No. Each storefront shows its own catalogue.
Can the customer use the same login on Shop A and B?	Yes. The active shop determines the shop context.
Are orders mixed together?	No. Orders belong to the shop where they were placed.
Can a user have different roles in different shops?	Yes. Membership and permissions are tenant-specific.

One person, different roles

Where	Person's role	What they can do there
Shop A	Manager	Manage the operations allowed by Shop A's manager permissions.
Shop B	Administrator / assigned role	Use only the permissions Shop B grants.
Shop C	Customer	Browse, order and manage their own customer activity.

The critical rule: being an administrator in Shop B must never make someone an administrator in Shop A. The system must check membership and permissions for the shop being accessed on every protected request.

What stays separate between shops

- Products, prices, promotions and stock.
- Orders, quotes, payments and receipts.
- Shop customer lists and private customer notes.
- Messages and appointments.
- Staff, roles and permissions.
- Business analytics, settings and shop branding.

Measurements belong to the customer and may be shared with a shop for a specific purpose, such as an order. Sharing with one shop must not automatically expose them to every other shop.

3. Roles: who uses Tailorly and what can they do?

A role is a set of permissions. Tailorly has platform-level roles and shop-level roles. These two groups must be kept separate.

Platform roles

Role	Plain-language responsibility
Super Admin	The platform owner. Oversees Tailorly itself: tenants, platform configuration, platform security, platform-wide reports and platform administrators.
Platform Admin	Handles approved platform operations such as onboarding reviews, assigned complaints and operational tasks. Does not automatically receive private access to every shop.
Platform Support Agent	Helps users with support and technical issues. Access to sensitive shop information must be limited, justified and recorded.

Shop-level roles

Role	Plain-language responsibility
Shop Owner	Owns and controls their own tailoring business: shop profile, products, orders, customers, staff, permissions, finance and settings.
Store Manager	Runs daily shop operations. Access to sensitive finance or staff controls only if the owner grants it.
Tailor / Fashion Designer	Works on assigned designs and orders, uses authorized measurements and updates sewing progress.
Store Staff	Completes assigned tasks and sees only the information needed for those tasks.
Delivery Personnel	Sees assigned delivery information and updates delivery status. Does not see unrelated customer or business records.
Customer	Browses shops and manages their own profile, orders, measurements, payments, messages, appointments and reviews.

Super Admin versus Shop Owner

Super Admin	Shop Owner
Controls the Tailorly platform.	Controls only their own shop.
Manages tenants and platform roles.	Manages their own staff and shop permissions.
Sees platform-wide operational summaries.	Sees their own shop's performance.
Exceptional tenant support access must be time-limited and audited.	Can access their own shop's operational data according to permissions.

No administrator should ever be able to view a user's password. Sensitive platform actions should use strong authentication and leave an audit record.

4. Feature catalogue: what Tailorly should do

This section is the product checklist. A feature should be marked complete only after its main user journey works, data is saved correctly, permissions are enforced and tests pass.

A. Main Tailorly website

- Landing page that clearly explains what Tailorly is and who it helps.
- About page, vision/mission and product story.
- How It Works guide for customers and shop owners.
- For Tailors page explaining the value of joining.
- Features and benefits page.
- Meet the Creator page with genuine biography, images, portfolio and social links.
- FAQ, help, contact and Get Started pages.
- Search-engine-friendly public pages and shareable links.

B. Account and security

- Register, log in, log out and verify email.
- Forgot-password and reset-password flows.
- One universal identity across all shops.
- Secure sessions and ability to revoke sessions.
- Tenant-aware sign-up and login based on the shop URL.
- Tenant-specific memberships, roles and permissions.
- Profile, addresses, privacy and account settings.

C. Shop storefront and branding

- Unique shop name, logo, colours and public profile.
- Business description, vision, mission, contact details and policies.
- Shop-specific homepage, navigation and catalogue.
- Product and service categories, collections and search.
- Custom domain support as a later capability.
- Trust badges only when verification has actually happened.

D. Products and fashion catalogue

- Product photos, descriptions, prices and availability.
- Sizes, colours, fabrics, patterns and other variants.
- Stock/inventory tracking.
- Ready-made fashion collections and featured designs.
- Wishlist, recently viewed and product recommendations where approved.

E. Custom sewing and measurements

- Customer submits a custom design request and reference images.
- Shop reviews the request and sends a quote.
- Customer accepts, declines or discusses the quote.
- Measurement Passport can hold multiple measurement profiles.
- Customer chooses what measurements to share and with which shop/order.
- Measurement history and order-specific snapshots support repeat orders.

F. Cart, checkout and payments

- Tenant-specific cart and checkout.
- Delivery or store pickup choice and clear totals.
- Paystack payment initialization and server-side verification.
- Deposits, balances, receipts and payment history.
- Payment failure, refund and reconciliation handling.

G. Orders and sewing progress

- Order received and accepted status.
- Measurement and fabric/design confirmation.
- Cutting, sewing, fitting and alteration stages.
- Quality inspection and ready-for-collection status.
- Delivery/collection confirmation and order history.
- Progress timestamps, estimated completion and delay updates.

H. Communication and appointments

- Private customer-shop messaging.
- Order-related conversation and file/photo sharing.
- Real-time updates using authenticated, tenant-safe Socket.IO rooms.
- Measurement appointments, fittings, rescheduling and reminders.
- Notifications for order, payment, message and appointment events.

I. Shop business management

- Customer relationship records for that shop.
- Staff invitations and role/permission assignment.
- Inventory and material usage.
- Invoices, receipts, expenses and outstanding balances.
- Revenue, order, product and customer analytics.
- Promotions, coupons, reviews and loyalty features.
- Multiple branches and other advanced operations when approved.

J. Platform management

- Tenant onboarding, status and account management.
- Platform admins and support-agent permissions.

- Platform-wide reporting and configuration.
- Complaint and dispute escalation.
- Security alerts, session controls and audit history.
- Temporary, scoped and audited tenant support access.

5. Important workflows in plain language

Registration flow

Step	What happens
1	Visitor opens a shop URL or the main Tailorly website.
2	If they open a shop URL, Tailorly identifies that shop from the trusted domain.
3	Visitor chooses Register or Login.
4	For a new user, Tailorly creates one universal account and sends an email verification link.
5	The shop relationship is recorded for the shop where registration started.
6	The customer browses that shop and can place an order.

Custom order flow

Customer submits a design idea and reference images → shop reviews it → shop sends a quote → customer accepts → measurement/fabric details are confirmed → order enters production → customer tracks progress → fitting/alteration if needed → quality check → collection or delivery → completion and review.

Ready-made order flow

Customer chooses a product and options → adds it to the current shop's cart → chooses delivery or pickup → reviews total → pays using an enabled method → shop receives the order → prepares it → dispatches or makes it ready for collection → customer confirms receipt.

Shop staff flow

Owner invites a staff member → staff member uses their existing Tailorly account or creates one → owner assigns a role for that shop → staff signs in → Tailorly checks that shop's membership and permissions → staff sees only permitted work.

Support access flow

A support need is recorded → authorized person requests access with a reason and scope → access is approved where required → access expires automatically → actions are written to an audit log. This is not silent impersonation.

6. Dashboards and navigation

Dashboards should be different because users have different jobs. A Super Admin is managing the platform; a Shop Owner is running one business; a customer is managing personal shopping activity.



Visual concept reference: Super Admin and Shop Owner dashboard. Use this as inspiration; the final interface must be functional, responsive and permission-aware.

Super Admin menu — suggested structure

- Overview / Platform Dashboard
- Tenants / Shops
- Platform Users & Roles
- Subscriptions & Plans (once the commercial model is confirmed)
- Platform Analytics & Revenue
- Complaints & Disputes
- Support Centre
- Security & Audit Centre
- Global Website / Platform Settings
- Integrations & System Health

Shop Owner menu — suggested structure

- Shop Overview
- Orders & Custom Requests
- Production / Sewing Board
- Products & Catalogue
- Customers
- Measurements (authorized access only)

- Messages & Appointments
- Payments, Invoices & Expenses
- Inventory & Materials
- Staff & Permissions
- Promotions, Reviews & Loyalty
- Storefront Design & Settings
- Reports & Analytics

Customer menu — suggested structure

- My Dashboard
- Discover Shops
- My Orders
- Measurements
- Messages
- Appointments
- Payments & Receipts
- Wishlist
- Reviews
- Notifications
- Settings & Support

The menu is a convenience, not a security boundary. The server must still reject unauthorized requests even if someone manually enters a URL.

7. Design and technology

Design standard

- Premium, clean, minimal and mobile-first.
- Navy `#173D78`, cyan `#21B8C9` and white as the core brand palette.
- Poppins or Inter typography.
- Clear buttons, readable forms, useful empty states and consistent spacing.
- Store owners can customize their own shop identity without changing the Tailorly platform brand.
- Use genuine shop imagery and founder information; do not invent testimonials, certifications or verification.

Technology direction

Technology	What it is used for
Next.js + TypeScript	The main application, public pages, storefronts and dashboards.
Tailwind CSS	Consistent responsive styling.
MongoDB + Mongoose	Store users, shops, products, orders and related records.
Cloudinary	Product photos and approved media uploads.
Paystack	Payment processing; payment status must be verified on the server.
Socket.IO	Live messages and updates with tenant-safe access checks.
Redis	Caching, rate limits or background coordination where useful.
Vitest + Playwright	Automated unit/integration and browser tests.
Docker	Repeatable development/deployment environment where needed.
GitHub + Student Pack resources	Version control and eligible student benefits.

Cost rule

Prefer free or GitHub Student Developer Pack resources, but check current eligibility, quotas, commercial-use terms and expiry before relying on a benefit. A free tier is not necessarily unlimited or suitable for production.

8. Privacy, security and trust

The most important technical risk in Tailorly is accidentally showing one shop another shop's private information. This must be treated as a core product requirement, not a later improvement.

Examples of what must never leak between shops

- Shop A's customer list must not appear in Shop B.
- Shop A's orders, messages, payments and internal notes must not be accessible from Shop B.
- A manager in Shop A must not gain manager rights in Shop B automatically.
- A shop must not see customer measurements unless the customer has authorized the relevant sharing.
- A socket event or cached result from one shop must not be delivered to another shop.

Security checklist

- Every private request checks the signed-in user, current tenant membership and required permission.
- Every tenant-owned database query is scoped to the resolved tenant.
- The server resolves tenant from a trusted domain mapping; it does not trust a tenantId supplied by the browser.
- Passwords are securely hashed; admins cannot view them.
- Sessions can be revoked; sensitive actions are audited.
- Payment confirmation is verified with Paystack server-side.
- Private uploads have access controls and file limits.
- Secrets are stored outside source control.

Admin access

Super Admin may need to help investigate a tenant issue, but should not silently browse private shop data. Use a reason, limited scope, short expiry and immutable audit history for exceptional support access.

9. Proposed implementation roadmap

The planning work proposed 12 phases. The final phase count and detailed boundaries still need explicit confirmation before being treated as locked. The sequence below is the current working proposal.

Phase	Main outcome	Evidence to request
1. Foundation	Project setup, database, shared design system and tenant-routing foundation.	App runs; DB connects; lint/build pass; architecture documented.
2. Authentication	Universal accounts, email verification and sessions.	Register/login/reset work; same identity can authenticate on two shops.
3. Customer experience	Customer profile, settings and account dashboard.	Customer can manage own account and see their own shop activity.
4. Public site & storefront base	Main Tailorly marketing site plus tenant storefront routing and branding.	Root site and two demo shops resolve independently.
5. Catalogue	Products, categories, variants, images and stock.	Shop A and B show different catalogues.
6. Custom orders & measurements	Design requests, quotes and measurement sharing.	Customer submits request; shop receives only authorized details.
7. Checkout & payments	Tenant cart, Paystack and receipts.	Payment verification and failure paths pass tests.
8. Production	Sewing board, assignments, fittings and progress.	Order moves through controlled workflow with history.
9. Messaging & delivery	Chat, notifications, appointments and delivery tracking.	Live events and delivery data remain tenant-scoped.
10. Business management	Staff permissions, inventory, analytics, promotions and reviews.	Owner controls own shop; staff permissions are enforced.
11. Super Admin	Platform control, tenant management, security and audit.	Platform roles and support access are tested.
12. Integration & launch	Regression, security, performance, deployment and documentation.	Release gates pass; backups and rollback are tested.

Every phase must include integration, automated/manual testing, bug fixing, documentation and a Git commit. Do not move to the next phase just because the current page looks finished.

10. Project progress tracker

Use this section during meetings or after every Copilot implementation session. Write the date, evidence and outstanding issues. You can print this page and update it by hand, or maintain a digital copy.

Phase	Status	Date started	Date tested	Evidence / notes
1. Foundation	Not started			
2. Authentication	Not started			
3. Customer experience	Not started			
4. Public site & storefront	Not started			
5. Catalogue	Not started			
6. Custom orders & measurements	Not started			
7. Checkout & payments	Not started			
8. Production	Not started			
9. Messaging & delivery	Not started			
10. Business management	Not started			
11. Super Admin	Not started			
12. Integration & launch	Not started			

Feature-level checklist

Feature / area	Not started	In progress	Testing	Complete
Main Tailorly public website	☐	☐	☐	☐
Tenant storefronts and custom branding	☐	☐	☐	☐
Universal account and tenant roles	☐	☐	☐	☐
Customer dashboard	☐	☐	☐	☐
Shop Owner dashboard	☐	☐	☐	☐
Super Admin dashboard	☐	☐	☐	☐
Catalogue and inventory	☐	☐	☐	☐
Custom orders and measurements	☐	☐	☐	☐
Checkout and Paystack	☐	☐	☐	☐
Production and progress tracking	☐	☐	☐	☐
Messaging, appointments and delivery	☐	☐	☐	☐

Feature / area	Not started	In progress	Testing	Complete
Business reports and staff permissions	☐	☐	☐	☐
Security, audit and tenant isolation	☐	☐	☐	☐
Deployment, backup and documentation	☐	☐	☐	☐

11. How to know a feature is truly finished

A page that looks attractive is not necessarily complete. Use this checklist before marking any feature as done.

- The feature matches the agreed requirement and user journey.
- It works on mobile and desktop.
- Buttons, links, forms, menus and filters perform their intended actions.
- Data saves and loads correctly after refresh or a new session.
- Validation and helpful error messages work.
- The right roles can use it; unauthorized roles are blocked on the server.
- Tenant A cannot read or change Tenant B's records.
- Automated tests pass and the main flow has been manually checked.
- No existing working feature was broken.
- Documentation and environment examples are updated.
- The code is committed to Git and the commit is identifiable.

Questions to ask Copilot or a developer after each task

- What exactly did you implement?
- Which files did you create, change or delete?
- Which tests did you run? Show the actual results.
- What is still incomplete or mocked?
- How did you test tenant isolation?
- What should I click or enter to verify it myself?
- Did you add a dependency or paid service? Is there a free GitHub Student alternative?
- What is the Git commit message?

Open decisions to resolve before the relevant work

Decision	Current status
Final brand name, tagline and logo	Working name Tailorly and proposed tagline; final lock pending.
Final hosting and email provider	Open; compare free/student options and production requirements.
Subscription plans and billing rules	Open; do not invent prices or entitlements.
Custom domains	Later capability proposed; initial launch scope to confirm.
Detailed customization permissions centre	Proposed; confirm exact permissions before implementation.
Final 12-phase structure	Proposed working roadmap; confirm before locking.

Product-owner reminder

Keep the product focused: first make the core experience secure and dependable—create a shop, brand it, publish products, receive an order, manage the work and serve the

customer. Advanced features should not compromise the basics.

Tailorly — One platform. Independent fashion businesses. Connected customer experiences.

This handbook describes the planned product and current decisions. Update it when the product owner approves changes. It does not certify that any feature has been implemented.